

that office suite files are safely backed up on the cloud and accessible across multiple hardware systems. This also allows you to make changes from anywhere and have them sync back to your own machine.

- ▶ **Compatibility - Export to PDF:** Document compatibility is a key issue at a time when there are so many versions of the same software in the market. Office suite packages tend to have different formats that are not compatible with each other. Only recently have office suite manufacturers made compatibility of document formats possible across different software, but this comes with the downside of unsupported fonts, formatting and style. Because of this, the Adobe PDF system has remained the standard format for final drafts, and a good office suite must have a feature which allows the document to be exported in a PDF format.
- ▶ **Multimedia support:** As documents have continued their migration away from print towards the internet and devices platform, the use of multimedia content in the form of embedded video, audio, animation, graphics and illustrations has also increased. New formats such as .ePub are used to make eBooks and can easily be written using office suites with the right training. All these developments make it necessary for office suites to have an efficient and powerful approach to providing value when using multimedia content. The office suite of the future needs to have simple multimedia tools that allow users to make basic edits to their videos, allow turnkey editing on photographs as well as allow for hyperlinking within the documents for ease of use and formatting.
- ▶ **Online collaboration:** As the nature of the internet changes, so does the way in which work is conducted and managed. The ability of an office suite to connect a number of people via the internet to work in an efficient and collaborative environment is slowly becoming a must. As co-workers may not necessarily be in the same town or country, an office suite application that connects people so they can seamlessly work in a common environment with effective communication and collaboration tools is the way of the future. The ability to work collaboratively in real time across vast distances is changing the way office work is done, not only improving productivity but also the lifestyles of the workers. Currently, this type of functionality is limited to corporate packages but there are Open Source free-to-use systems that are also letting you explore this feature. 